Intergroup Behavior & Group Conflict



The Self & Social Identities

Paper 1: AI and Your Identities

Step 1: Describe Yourself

Before using ChatGPT, write brief responses (bullet points or short sentences) to prompts about yourself. You do not need to answer every prompt—choose those that feel most relevant to your experiences and identities.

Your Identities

- What social identities are most important to you now versus before?
- Which identities do you think about most often?
- Which identities do you rarely think about?

Your Experiences

- Describe a time when one of your identities became especially salient.
- Describe a time when you strongly felt that you belonged.
- Describe a time when you felt excluded, misunderstood, or stereotyped.
- Which identities are seen versus not seen?

Your Relationships

- What communities or groups do you feel most connected to?
- Are there identities that overlap, complement, or conflict with one another?
- Are there aspects of your identity that you think other people often misunderstand?

Your Values

- What values are most important to you?
- How have your identities shaped those values?
- What do you wish other people understood about your identities?

Paper 1: AI and Your Identities

Step 2: Ask ChatGPT
Copy your responses into ChatGPT. Then ask ChatGPT:

"Based on the information below, write a 500-word summary describing my social identities, how they shape my experiences, and what these identities might mean to me."

Please do not tell ChatGPT that this is for a class assignment (that will affect its reply!). The goal is to observe how it naturally interprets the information you provide. You may ask one or two follow-up questions if you would like clarification, but do not substantially rewrite your prompt or repeatedly correct ChatGPT's interpretation.

An Important Consideration
Remember that ChatGPT can only interpret the information you choose to provide. Its summary is based not only on what you included, but also on what you omitted. As you analyze the response, think carefully about how your own choices shaped ChatGPT's interpretation.

- Which identities, experiences, or values did you emphasize?
- Which did you leave out?
- How might someone who knows you well describe you differently?
- To what extent are ChatGPT's assumptions a product of the information you provided versus broader cultural expectations, stereotypes, or social norms?

Paper 1: AI and Your Identities

Step 3: Write Your Analysis (4–8 pages)
Write a thoughtful analysis of the AI interaction.

Like any strong psychology paper, your analysis should make an overall argument or thesis. Rather than answering each question separately, identify one or two central ideas about how AI interpreted your identities and use evidence from both the ChatGPT conversation and course concepts to support your argument.

Consider questions such as:

- What aspects of ChatGPT's description felt accurate?
- What did it misunderstand, oversimplify, or completely miss?
- What assumptions did ChatGPT make?
- Which assumptions seemed to come directly from the information you provided, and which appeared to reflect broader cultural expectations, stereotypes, or social norms?
- How did the information you chose to include shape ChatGPT's interpretation?
- Were there important aspects of your identity or experiences that you did not include? How might the summary have changed if you had?
- If someone who knows you well had answered these prompts about you, how might ChatGPT's summary have been different?
- Did ChatGPT emphasize some identities while minimizing others? Why do you think it did this?
- Did reading the summary make you think about yourself or your identities differently?
- What are the strengths and limitations of using AI to understand a person's identity?

Finally, connect your analysis to at least three key ideas, theories, concepts, or empirical findings from this course. Your goal is not simply to define these ideas, but to use them to explain why ChatGPT responded the way it did and what this exercise reveals about identity, social categorization, stereotyping, belonging, self-presentation, or person perception.

Paper 1: AI and Your Identities

Outline of Assignment (20 points)
Before submitting your final paper, you will submit a brief outline (approximately 1-2 pages)

AI Interaction & Initial Reflection (5 points)

- What information did you choose to provide ChatGPT?
- What was ChatGPT's overall interpretation of your identities?
- What was your initial reaction to the summary?

Course Concepts (10 points)
Identify at least three theories, concepts, or empirical findings from class. What is the concept? How does it relate to your analysis?

Paper Organization (5 points)
Include a brief outline of your paper plan

Final Paper (80 points)

Please submit one Microsoft Word document:

1. Your original responses to the prompts.
2. The complete ChatGPT conversation (including your prompts and ChatGPT's responses).
3. Your 4–8 page analysis.
4. Double-spaced, APA Formatted where appropriate
5. 12-point font, 1-inch margins
6. Your paper will be submitted electronically through Canvas.

Prompt Responses & ChatGPT Interaction (5 points)

- Includes the original responses to the prompts (2)
- Includes the complete ChatGPT conversation (2)



Duke is competing against UNC. Which of these people feels most like "us"?

A Duke student from your hometown

A UNC student who shares your major

A Duke student who is very different from you politically

A UNC student who is your best friend



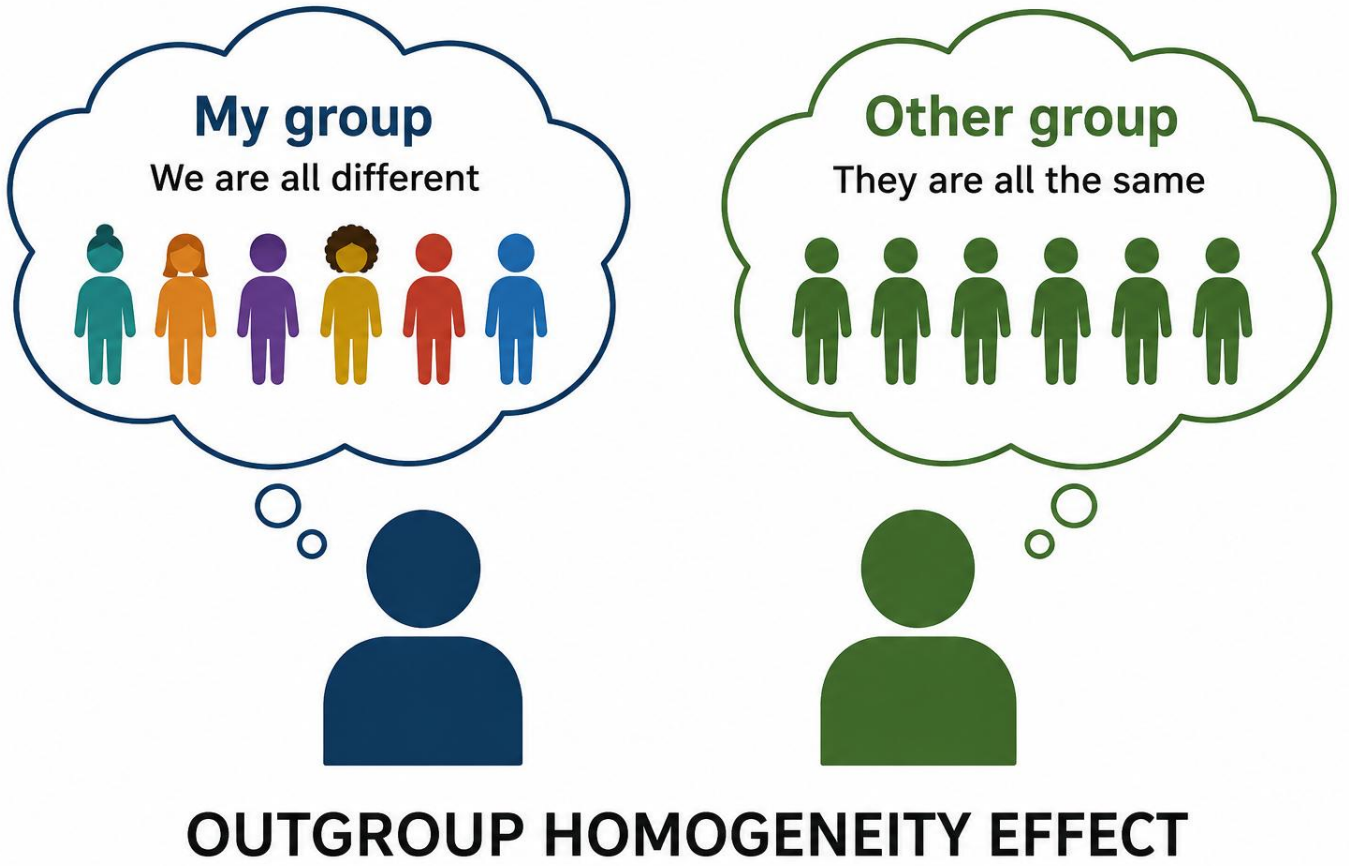
Your Brain Categorizes Instantly

Within **100–200 milliseconds**, our brains rapidly notice cues like:

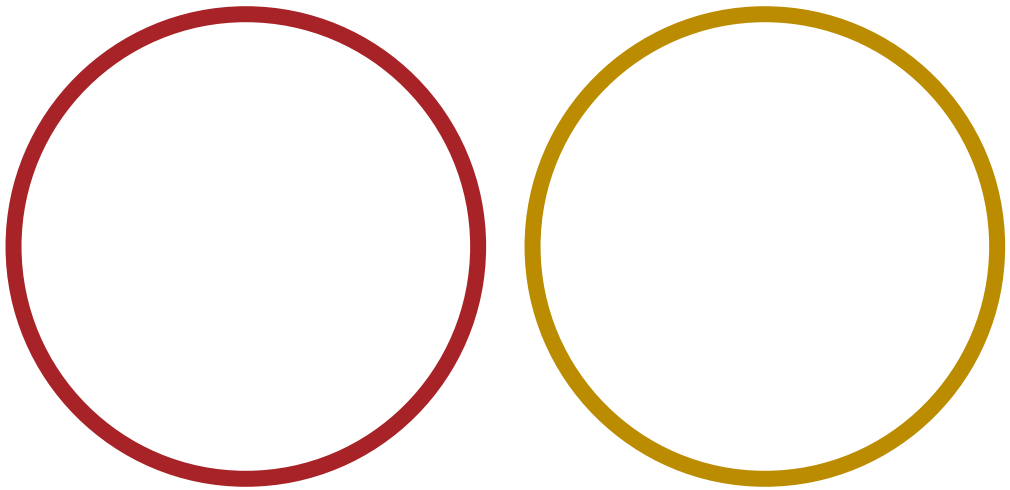
Age, Gender, Race & Ethnicity, Emotional expression, Clothing & group symbols

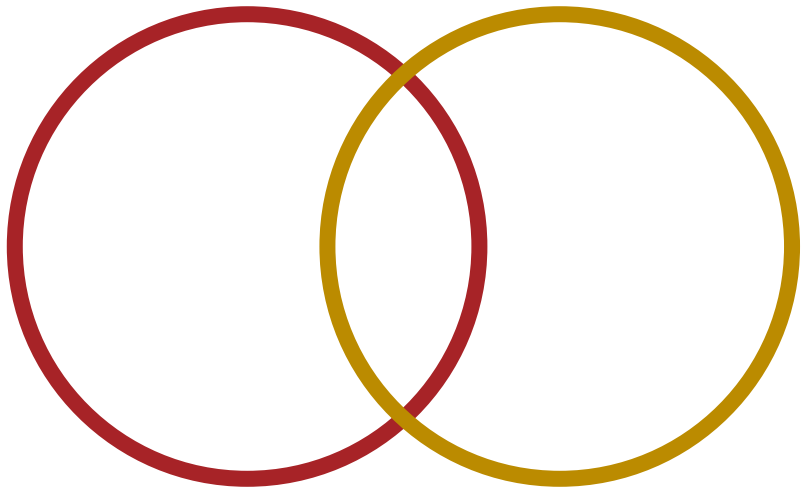
Categorization is automatic—it happens before conscious thought.

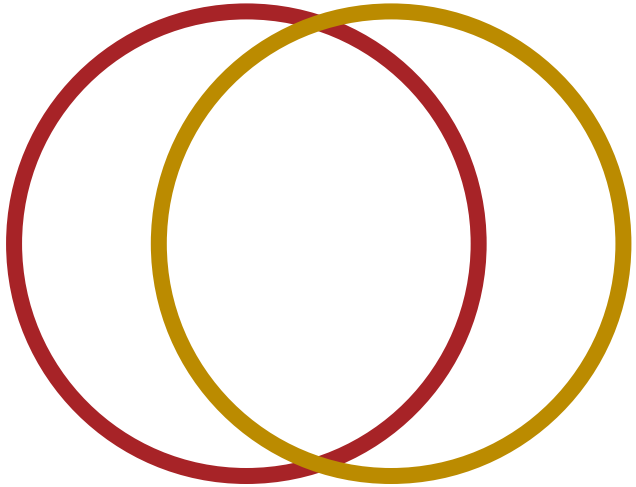
Categorization Has Its Consequences

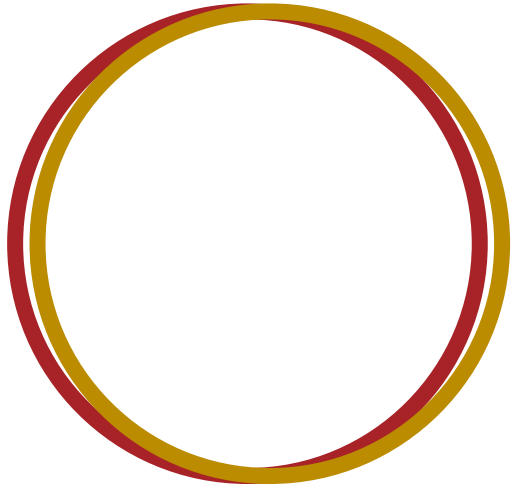


Think of Two Groups That Are Really Important To You









Ingroup Bias Everyday

Ingroup Bias: *The tendency to favor members of our own group*

Examples:

- Choosing familiar classmates for group projects
- Trusting recommendations from people "like us"
- Cheering for "our team" over "their team"



Tajfel's Intergroup Conflict Theory



- Tajfel and Turner are some of the most cited researchers of all time

- <u>(RCT) Realistic Group Conflict Theory:</u>
  - There needs to be some competition between groups to form a group identity
  - Usually over a limited amount of resources, some argue real or perceived scarcity is key
  - Leads to prejudice and discrimination toward the outgroup

Tajfel's Intergroup Conflict Theory



- Intragroup vs. Intergroup?
  - Intergroup competition increases intragroup morale
- Interpersonal vs. Intergroup?
  - Interaction between two individual people vs. interactions between two groups with established traits
- What is required to create intergroup conflict?
  - Group distance and conflict—the more intense the division, the more exaggerated behavior

Tajfel's Intergroup Conflict Theory



- Social Mobility?
  - a person's belief systems about the structure between groups and whether they are malleable or not
  - often linked with access to resources

- But how can someone in a lower status group still view a higher status group positively? This goes against RCT…
  - Identity conflict and complexity
  - Desire to be in the majority, desire to be "better" or to have power

What is needed to form intergroup conflict?



- Incompatible beliefs or interests
- Differential access to resources
- Ingroup bias or favoritism
- But this is true for even minimal groups or groups without real meaning…
- Demonstrates how malleable identity can be across groups and contexts

Theoretical Principles of Group Identity



- Individuals strive to achieve and maintain a positive identity
- Positive social identification is based on favorable comparisons to an outgroup
- When someone's social identity is negative, they strive to leave or better that group
- Agree? Disagree? What other rules do you think there might be?

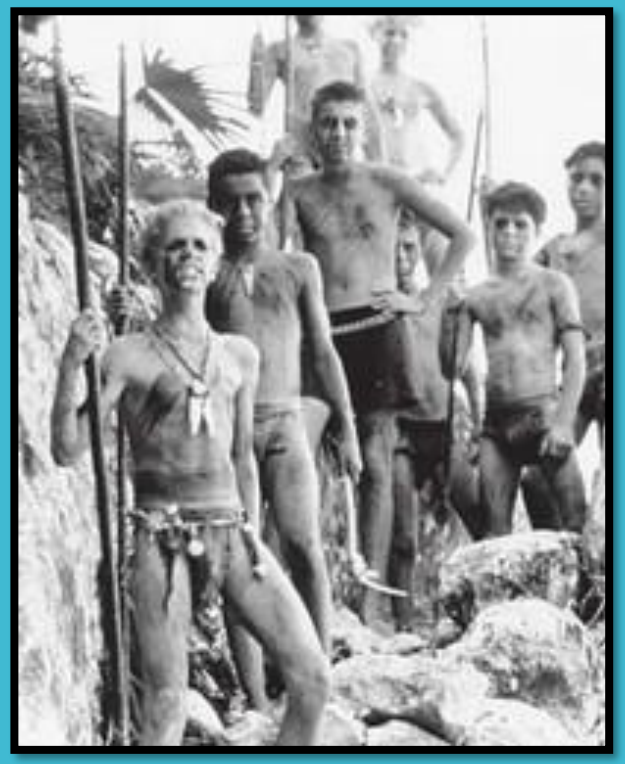
Three Variables that Predict Group Membership



- 1) You must internalize that group as a part of your self-concept
- 2) The social context must allow for comparisons
- 3) A comparable outgroup is available for direct evaluation and differentiation

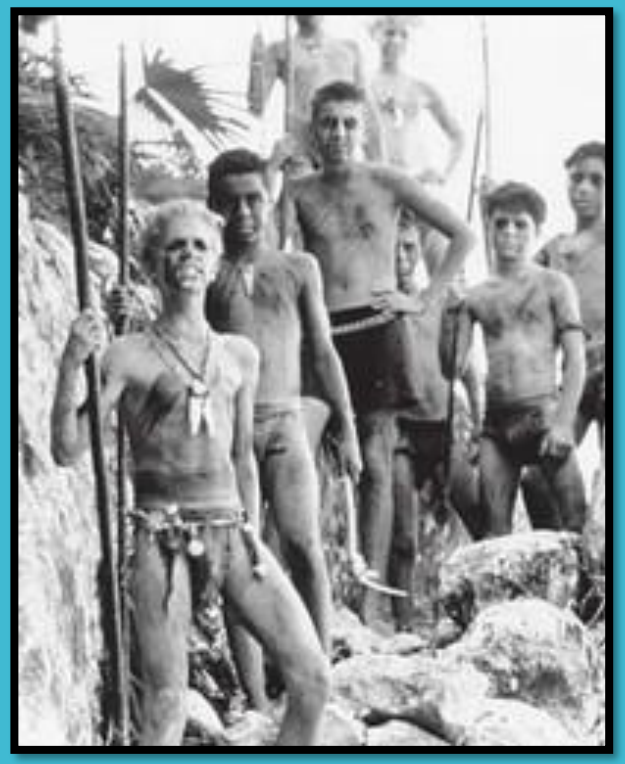
- What are famous group conflicts you can think of? Do they fit with these variables?

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study



- <u>To Test Realistic Conflict Theory</u>
  - Create conflict vs. cooperation between groups
  - Research Question:
    - When and how does prejudice arise between groups?
  - Methods:
    - 22 White eleven-twelve year old boys
    - Observation of behavior and friendship patterns across different phases

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study



- **Study Phases:**
  - **Phase 1:** Group Acquaintanceship
  - **Phase 2:** Group Differentiation (Eagles & Rattlers)
  - **Phase 3:** Competition (tournaments, chores, prizes)
  - **Phase 4:** Cooperation (reducing intergroup hostility)

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study—Becoming Friends



Selecting tent poles to take on their overnight hike.



Rattlers practice tent pitching.

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study—Becoming Friends



Rattlers reading a clue on the group Treasure Hunt.



Preparing and serving a meal.

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study—Rattlers vs. Eagles

(STAGE 2)



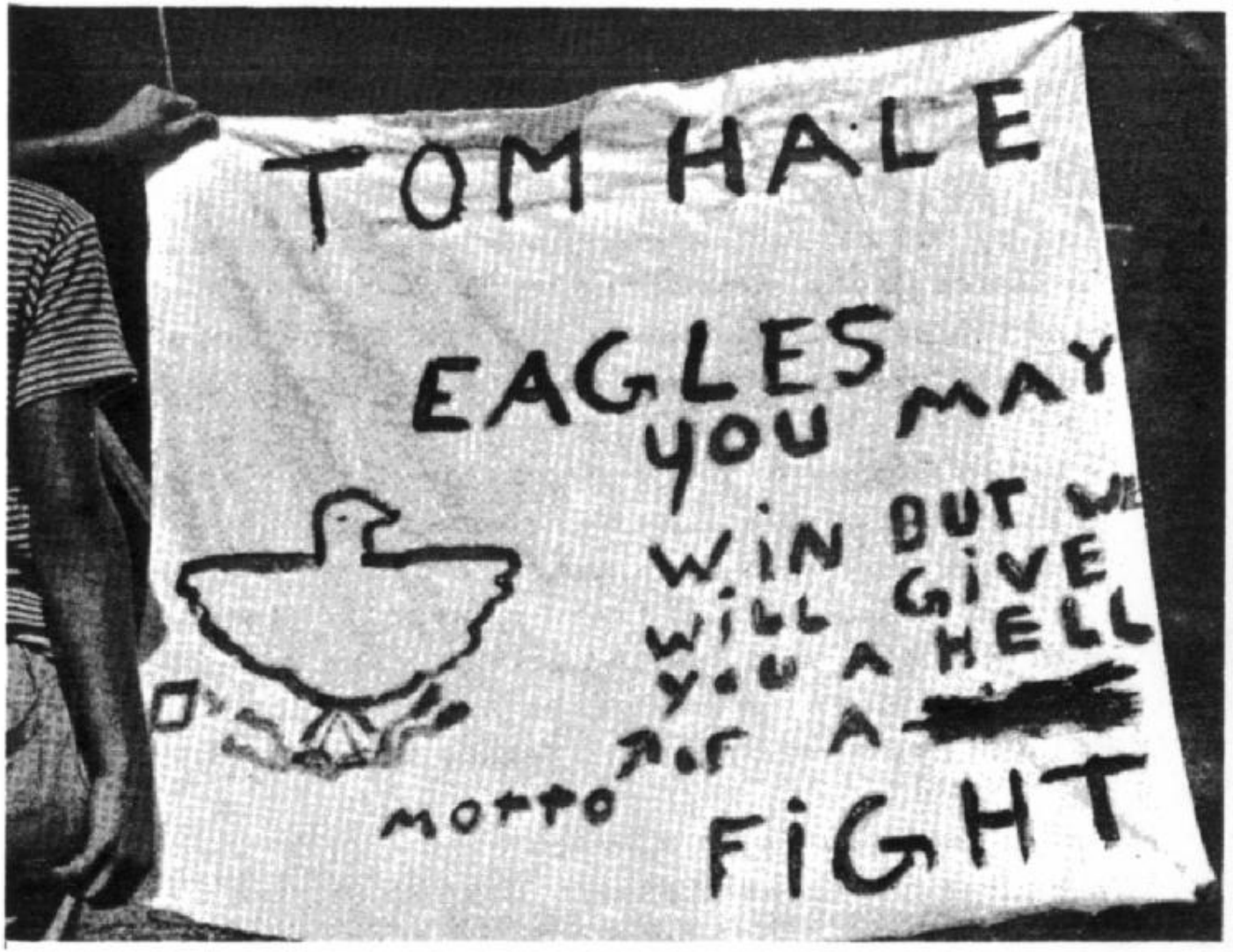
Rattlers put their flag on backstop of ball diamond, which they appropriated after improving it.



Initial encounter between groups: Rattlers ("home team") watch intently as Eagles approach.

RATTLERS AND EAGLES: INTERGROUP RELATIONS

(STAGE 2)



One of the Eagle banners during the tournament.

Sherif (1966) Robbers Cave Study—Results?



- Competitive goals cause inter-group conflict
  - But others suggest that competition is not a necessary condition for hostile feelings towards the outgroup?
- Superordinate goals and cooperation increases cross-group friends
- What theory supports these results?
  - Social Identity Theory or Self-Categorization

Minimal Group Paradigm: Tajfel 1971

How little does it take to create group bias?

TAJFEL ET AL. (1971) – MINIMAL GROUP STUDY

Participants were told they would be placed in a group based on their preference for paintings.

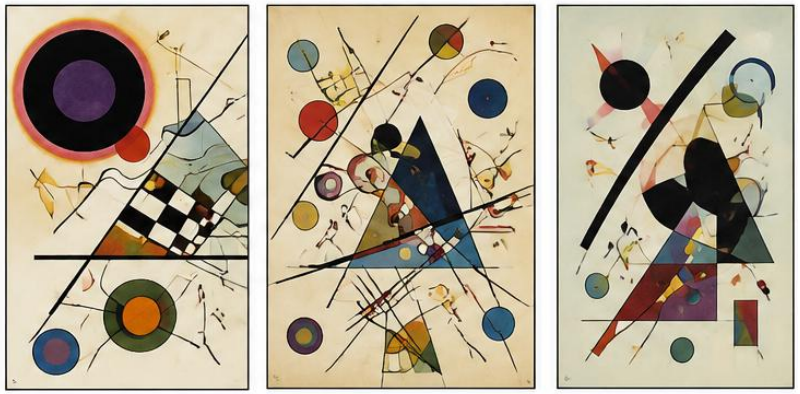
"Which do you prefer?"

KLEE
(Group A)



"Klee paintings"
(Preference = Group A)

KANDINSKY
(Group B)



"Kandinsky paintings"
(Preference = Group B)

In reality, half of the participants were randomly assigned to Group A and half to Group B.

What Happened?

Participants consistently:

- Allocated more rewards to their ingroup
- Favored their ingroup
- Chose options that maximized the difference between groups

Ingroup Favoritism

“Blue eyes, Brown Eyes” Jane Elliot (1968)/Oprah 1992



Intergroup Contact on the Soccer Field

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Social cohesion after war

Christian and Muslim soccer in post-ISIS Iraq



Building social cohesion between Christians and Muslims through soccer in post-ISIS Iraq

Salma Mousa

Cooperative, equal-status contact through soccer built lasting Christian–Muslim peer relationships after ISIS—but did not fully erase broader prejudice toward Muslim strangers.

Class Discussion



- What limitations are there to intergroup conflict theory and these studies (Robbers Cave, Brown Eyes, Soccer Teams)?
- How does it vary for groups we strongly dislike vs. no history?

Class Discussion



Social identity theory shows that people can favor an ingroup even when the group distinction is arbitrary. Does a strong sense of 'us' necessarily require a 'them'?

How does online activity help shape group identity?

Next Classes…



- Discussion Questions Due Monday by 2pm!
- Tuesday: Self Esteem
- Thursday: Cultural Identities With Dr. Cristina Salvador & Paper 1 Outline Due by 9am!